

The Detective Kit

Print only the pages you want. The pages for building your own case work in black and white.

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The Case of the Missing Sock



Nova has a dog named Pip. Pip is small and white and so fluffy that he looks like a cloud with eyes.

One Saturday morning, Nova could not find her left sock. It was her favorite one, the striped one, and it was not in the drawer.

Milo came over with his notebook. "Let us do this properly," he said. "Where was it last?"

"On the chair," said Nova. "I put both socks on the chair last night."

Milo wrote that down. Then he looked at the chair. One sock was still there. The other was gone.

"So it did not walk away by itself," he said. "Someone moved it."



The story continues

They made a list. Nova's brother had been in the room, but he had been carrying a bowl of cereal with both hands. Nova's mother had come in to open the window, but she had gone straight out again. And Pip had been asleep under the chair.

"Three suspects," said Milo. "Three stories."

Nova looked at the list for a long time. "Wait," she said. "Pip was under the chair. The sock was on the chair. Pip is the only one who was close enough."

They found Pip in the hall. He was lying in his basket with the striped sock tucked under his chin, very pleased with himself.

"He did not steal it," said Nova. "Look at him. He kept it."

Milo wrote one more line in his notebook. Then he read it out loud.

"Case closed. The sock smelled like the park."

Pip thumped his tail twice and did not give the sock back.



Nova



Nova is eight, and the kind of eight who reads the map before anyone asks for it.

Milo



Milo is eight and the oldest of three.

Detective Cards

Cut out a card and write your name on it. Now you are the detective.

DETECTIVE

DETECTIVE

DETECTIVE

DETECTIVE



Build Your Own Case

									
NAME	BLACK LOAFERS	BLUE BACKPACK	BLUE BERET	BROWN BOOTS	CANVAS TOTE BAG	CLIPPED MITTENS	DINOSAUR CAP	EXPLORER HAT	DRAW YOUR OWN

1. Write a name in each row. These are your suspects.
2. Give every suspect three items. Put a cross in three boxes on their row.
3. Choose three clues. Mark them with a dot at the top of the grid.
4. Check your case. Only the thief may have a cross in all three clue columns.

Build Your Own Case

									
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Your Clues

Write your three clues in the order you will reveal them.

CLUE 1 _____

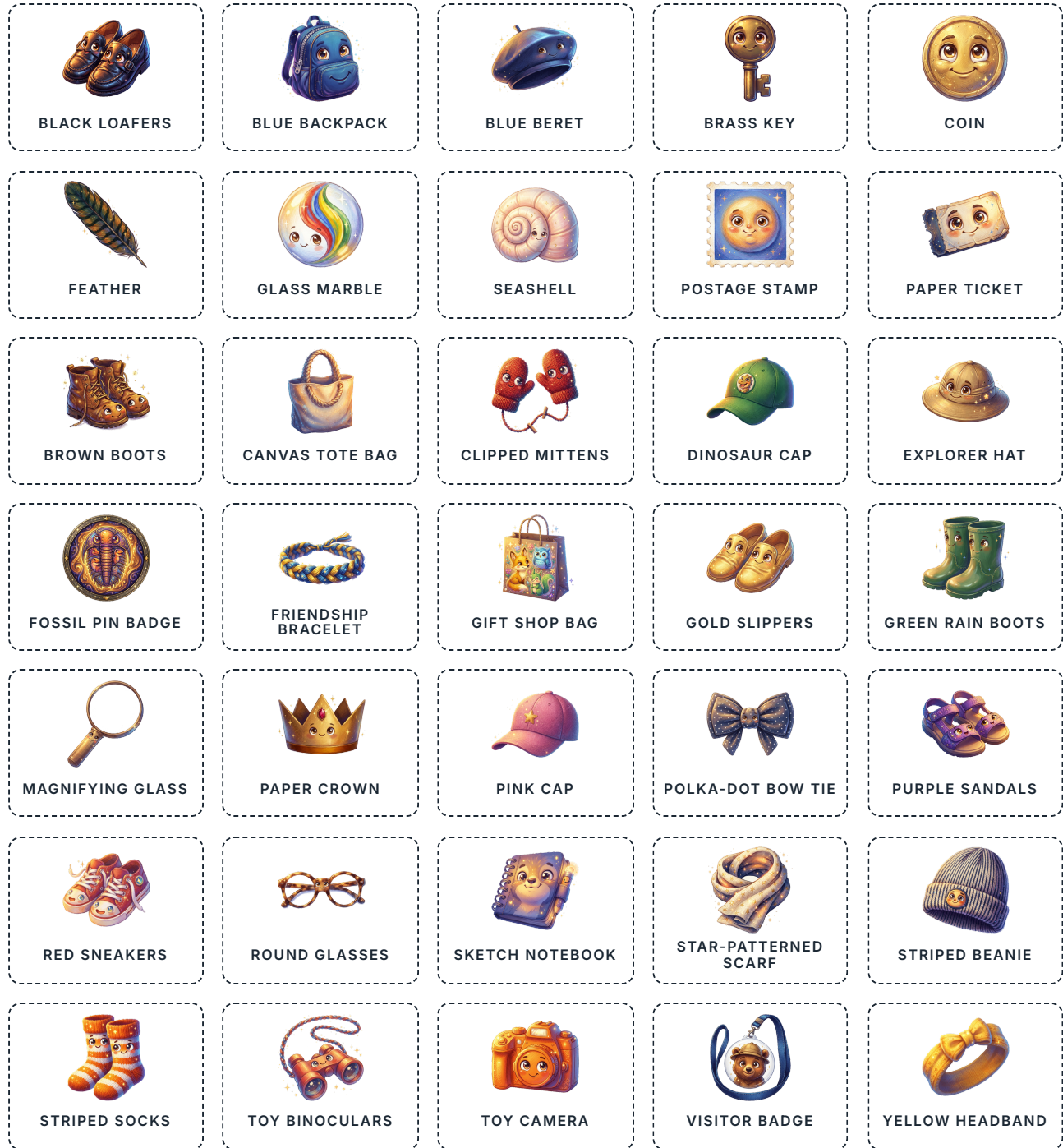
CLUE 2 _____

CLUE 3 _____

THE THIEF IS _____

Items to Cut Out

Cut these out if you want to move them around. You do not need to — the grid works without them.



Suspect Cards

Cut out the cards. Give every suspect three items — draw them, or cut them from the item sheet.



NAME _____



NAME _____



NAME _____



NAME _____

Case Closed

This detective built a case of their own, gave every suspect three items, and found the one who had all three clues.

DETECTIVE _____

DATE _____



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